



TODAY
THERE ARE
118
KNOWN
ELEMENTS

Working on the problem one night, he fell asleep in front of his cards. He had a dream about playing Solitaire—and woke

One of the most exciting things about Mendeleev's table was that it made it possible to predict the properties of the elements that would fill the gaps simply because of their positions. By 1888, he was proved right: his three gaps had been filled by the new elements gallium, scandium, and germanium.

Mendeleev realized that the missing pieces in the periodic table “jigsaw” were new elements that were yet to be discovered.

